

PDF file name: Jstor-2018-Indoor Air Pollution and Infant Mortality

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Title of the article: *Indoor Air Pollution and Infant Mortality: A New Approach*

The content extracted is as follows:

In most developing countries, cooking fuels emit indoor air pollutants that may lead to poor health.

The magnitude of this correlation varies widely across studies, and a causal link has not been clearly established. Even though indoor air pollution is one major threat to global health, economists have only recently become interested in this issue.¹ In cross-sectional studies, risks of alternative fuels and cooking stoves can be confounded by the use of multiple fuels, not all of which may be reported, plus many unobserved factors that may be associated with cooking fuel choices.

First, pollutants from burning cooking fuel are anecdotally the largest source of indoor air pollution.

Four fewer infants died per 10,000 live births than would have in the absence of the program.

I suggest that policy interventions that focus on reducing the use of kerosene and providing cleaner fuel alternatives (e.g., LPG) can be a way to reduce infant mortality rate.

II. Data

I define infant mortality as death within one year of birth.

III. Empirical Framework

I use a difference-in-difference (DID) estimation strategy and compare within district and birth year average infant mortality rate between targeted and untargeted regions, following the below equation: where y_{irt} is the outcome variable for infant i in region r at time t which takes the value of 1 if the infant died and 0 otherwise.

V. Discussion and Conclusion

This study finds a causal link between switching to cleaner fuel and infant mortality.

However, this study needs further investigation to confirm that the reduction in indoor air pollution induced by the program is the main mechanism that explains the reduction in infant mortality.

By 2011, the program prevented at least 600 infant deaths annually.⁷ Extrapolating this estimate globally, if one billion kerosene users in the developing world switched to LPG it would save about 7,000 infants per year.